Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Glasfryn (L'Arche)

Glasfryn House, Bailihelig Road, Brecon, LD3 8EB

01874610136

https://www.larche-brecon.org.uk/

The inspection visit took place on 16/09/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	L'Arche
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability
Registered places:	6
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Glasfryn L'Arche is residential care home which provides assisted living for up to six younger adults. It is situated in a rural setting just outside Brecon in the county of Powys.

Wellbeing is good. People speak positively about the service and the care they receive as they have highly effective working relationships with care staff. People are supported to remain as healthy as possible as the service links closely with health and medical professionals.

Care and support are good. Care staff understand people well and use this knowledge to deliver care in a dignified, respectful and responsive manner.

Leadership and management are good. People are supported by care staff with the necessary expertise, skills and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. The provider follows safe recruitment and induction processes.

The environment is good. People told us they are happy with their surroundings and felt

comfortable living at the service. The atmosphere within the home is calm, relaxed and welcoming.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People live healthily and safely with control over their lives. People appeared relaxed and content throughout the inspection. People told us, *"It's nice, I'm happy".* Another said, *"Its good. "We* observed care staff interacting in a calm, sensitive and reassuring way, adapting their approach when individuals were confused or unsettled. Care staff consistently used kind and respectful language, promoting dignity and emotional well-being through positive, person-centred engagement. People were observed to seek reassurance and social interaction from care staff, reflecting positive and trusting relationships. This contributes to a stable and emotionally supportive environment.

People are safe and protected from abuse and neglect. During our inspection, we saw people being treated with dignity and respect. Throughout the inspection, we observed warm, natural interactions between care staff and people, with care staff demonstrating a good understanding of people's preferences and needs. Risks are understood and managed appropriately, enabling people to be supported safely while maintaining as much independence as possible.

People are supported to cultivate safe and healthy relationships through open visiting arrangements and continued links with the wider community. The service has developed positive community connections. This inclusive approach strengthens relationships and helps people remain connected to those important to them. People and their families are included in improving service delivery through regular meetings facilitated by the service. We heard how the service uses proactive approaches to engage with people, enabling them to share their views and experiences in a meaningful and creative way. This ensures feedback is gathered at a pace suitable for individuals and is not rushed, supporting inclusive and person-centred involvement.

People live in accommodation which supports their well-being outcomes. People are able to choose when to get up, chose their own meal options and can decide whether to take part in activities. There are suitable opportunities for engagement, with a varied programme which reflects people's interests. There is a cabin located in the garden where people can engage in activities. There is a television lounge and a recently renovated dining / living area. Personalised initiatives, support meaningful occupation and enhance well-being. Care staff also demonstrated awareness of individuals who may be less likely to engage in group activities and supported them through one-to-one interaction, ensuring they remain included.

Some care staff speak Welsh; however this is limited therefore there is restricted provision of the Welsh language. Although some staff have basic Welsh, further development is needed to fully support the active offer.

Care & Support — Good

People receive the quality of care and support they need to achieve their personal outcomes. Care staff understand people well and use this knowledge to deliver care in a dignified, respectful and responsive manner. We observed staff responding promptly to people's needs, providing reassurance and appropriate support. Families told us care staff go out of their way to engage positively with people, supporting meaningful interactions and ensuring their needs are met. families told us, *"[relative] is treated well."*

People are protected from harm and abuse. We reviewed a sample of personal plans and found they contained information about people's backgrounds, preferences and daily routines. People's personal plans outline how care staff should support them to achieve their well-being outcomes. Personal plans provided care staff with guidance on how to support people safely whilst promoting choice, independence and dignity. Records showed plans are reviewed regularly and updated when people's circumstances change. Plans are written in a person-centred way, reflecting people's individual histories, preferences and outcomes. The service actively encourages families and representatives to be involved in reviews where appropriate, helping to ensure support remains relevant and responsive to people's needs. A relative told us, *"Yes, I always come to reviews. I want to be involved."* We also saw evidence of involvement from healthcare professionals, including GPs, district nurses and specialist services, when additional support or advice was required.

People's medication is safely managed. People receive medication in a safe, person-centred way considering choice, individuality and best practice guidelines. There are good clear medication management policies and procedures in place. We saw care staff are confident in managing and administering medication. There is thorough and regular medication training for care staff and no evidence of any recent mistakes or people missing their medication. There are good procedures in place for the management of medication at the service. Designated care staff are trained to administer medication. There is a designated medication room which is secure, when not in use. The rooms are clear of clutter and over stock and good procedures are in place to make sure medication is stored at optimum conditions. We looked at medication administration records (MAR) and found all medication is documented correctly. No gaps were visible in the records viewed.

People's risk of infection is minimised. People's risk of cross infection is minimised. An infection prevention and control policy underpins staff practice. Personal protective equipment (PPE) is readily available and used appropriately. The care staff conduct cleaning schedules and the home is free from malodour. The laundry systems are well organised.

Environment

Good

People live in an environment with appropriate and well-maintained facilities and equipment. Bedrooms are appropriately sized, personalised to reflect people's preferences and are able to accommodate people's personal effects. We saw the décor, furnishings and other items in people's bedrooms reflect their personality and interests with items important to individuals on display, supporting a sense of identity and belonging.

The service is situated in its own grounds which are well maintained and easily accessible. This space provides opportunities for people to spend time outdoors, socialise, eat with relatives and enjoy fresh air when they choose. People told us they are happy with their surroundings and felt comfortable living at the service. The atmosphere within the home was calm, relaxed and welcoming. We saw people choosing where they wished to spend their time throughout the day and moving freely between communal areas. People appeared familiar with their surroundings and comfortable accessing different parts of the home.

During the inspection, we found communal areas are clean, tidy and well maintained. Bedrooms are personalised with photographs, ornaments and personal possessions, helping people maintain a sense of identity and belonging. People had access to a variety of communal spaces where they could relax, socialise, meet visitors or participate in activities. The layout of the home supported people to move around safely and independently wherever possible.

Arrangements are in place to keep people safe within the environment. Health and safety systems are well managed, with routine checks and monitoring supporting ongoing improvement. Environmental checks, servicing and repairs are completed in line with agreed schedules, and external contractors carry out specialist work where required. Fire safety systems are robust. Regular checks take place and care staff receive appropriate training to ensure people can be supported safely in the event of a fire.

Records confirm routine testing of utilities. Substances hazardous to health are stored safely and securely. Water safety checks, including legionella risk assessments, are completed. Fire drills are completed. Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans (PEEPs) are in place and provide clear guidance for safe evacuation during emergencies. The service provider ensures the premises comply with current legislation and national guidance related to health and safety, environmental health and standards set by the Food Standards Agency.

The gardens are well maintained. There is a lodge present in the garden, currently being used for care staff training. In the summer months, it will be possible for people to spend quality time outside. Overall, the environment is safe, clean, aesthetically pleasing and well maintained, providing a setting which supports people's comfort, dignity and independence.

Leadership & Management — Good

People are supported to achieve their outcomes because the service provider has effective organisational arrangements, governance and oversight to ensure smooth operations and high-quality care. The service benefits from effective leadership and management, with well-established governance arrangements which support the delivery of safe, high-quality care. They demonstrate a reflective approach, which supports ongoing improvement and helps ensure good outcomes for people living at the service.

People are supported by care staff with the necessary expertise, skills and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. The provider follows safe recruitment and induction processes. Care staff are appropriately vetted and receive structured support when they begin their roles. Training is comprehensive and compliance levels are good. Care staff told us training prepares them well to carry out their responsibilities. Care staff maintain the required professional registrations with Social Care Wales which supports safe and competent practice. Supervision and appraisal processes are in place and are used to support development and address any practice issues in a timely way.

Care staff spoke positively about the management team and consistently described managers as approachable, supportive and visible within the service. Care staff told us they feel able to raise concerns, seek advice and discuss ideas openly. Many spoke positively about the culture within the home and described feeling valued, respected and supported in their roles.

The service provider has strict selection and vetting processes for recruiting staff to make sure all staff are qualified and trustworthy. People are involved in the recruitment process for care staff. We saw all care staff undergo routine and regular checks to ensure they remain suitably fit to work in the service and are appropriately registered with professional bodies. We found staff human resource files to be a very high standard and well organised with all the appropriate information made easily available for us to view.

People benefit from a positive culture which is supportive, inclusive, and respectful. Leaders are visible role models as they guide the strategic direction of the service. The responsible individual (RI) is accessible and well known to people, staff and visiting relatives and professionals. They have effective governance arrangements and maintain oversight of the service.

Overall, people have very high levels of confidence in the service because leaders make sure there is a very strong positive culture which is supportive, inclusive and respectful. Leaders guide the strategic direction of the service and the pace of change.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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